



Trial run: Ahead of both Under-19 Women's T20 World Cups (in 2023 and 2025), there were preparatory series organised for the Indian side. They proved vital — in both editions, the Indian side was triumphant.. PTI

for BCCI's emerging age-group and target camps. They undergo these high-performance camps for three months, which are then backed with matches," she told *Sportstar*.

The BCCI has long run these development programmes, focused on nurturing talent at every level. The months after the domestic season, from April to August, mark the real grind. The work behind the scenes has always existed, but the growing popularity of women's cricket has finally put a spotlight on it.

Selection is only the entry point; what follows is sustained immersion. "There is a lot of skill work that goes on. Some may come in exceptionally skilled. But even if they are 20 per

cent skilled, all of us in the coaching unit start working with them. Such players are identified throughout the year, via scouting and carefully maintained reports," said Nooshin, who coached the Indian U-19 women's side to consecutive World Cup titles.

"They spend so much time at the CoE (Centre of Excellence), using the facilities several times a day to constantly learn. It is useful preparation for these youngsters to be around the CoE, working with high-quality coaches and upgrading themselves. "They are also given India A tours or Under-19 tours. It gives them that extra opportunity to rub shoulders with teams from other countries and understand the conditions," Nooshin said.

Over the last two years, India A has toured Australia for all-format series against its A team, with seven matches each in both 2024 and 2025, offering vital exposure to a mix of capped and uncapped players. At the Under-19 level,

preparatory series were held ahead of the 2023 and 2025 T20 World Cups — against New Zealand and South Africa in 2022, and in a triangular series featuring South Africa and two Indian teams, A and B, in 2024. These tours reflected a structured approach to ensure competitive exposure across levels.

Forging the future

This continuity explains why many WPL discoveries arrive already tactically aware and mentally prepared. Their talent is unmistakable, but the shaping happens elsewhere. "Anushka was part of last year's Emerging Camp. Triveni Vasistha also did well in that camp. Vaishnavi Sharma was not picked in the WPL, but she has been part of the high-performance camps for the last two years.

"In the last three domestic tournaments, Vaishnavi was the highest wicket-taker, which allowed her to don India colours, and from there she was picked for Mumbai